# Forma Platform Product Definition

*Product purpose features experience and decisions*

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**Forma is a platform where teams build, run, and share AI-generated apps over their company data.** A team brings its data and tools into a company workspace, describes a defined job, and creates an app that combines the views, rules, context, and interactions needed to do that work. Colleagues can open the shared work or reuse the app with their own permitted data.

**The app becomes both the thing people share and the place they do the work.** A spreadsheet can be an input. A conversation can express intent. The durable result is a working application with an owner, a known version, appropriate access, and saved work that another person can understand.

Forma is the company platform. Security is its first application family, demonstrated through Northstar's outbound investigation workflow. Other company spaces can contain finance, operations, support, or other validated apps built through the same product. Typing /security and clicking Security open the same space, with its relevant apps, context, and visual identity.

This document defines the product to build, its users, behavior, scope, positioning, and remaining decisions. It is the current platform definition. The earlier security document remains the detailed starting point for the first application family. The original demonstrations remain separate reference material.

**Decision status:** Confirmed direction comes from the conversation. Adopted defaults resolve ordinary product choices so the team can proceed. Open decisions appear in the final section with a recommended default and the evidence needed to resolve them.

**Implementation status:** The capabilities below describe the intended product. Forma Stack 3.0.0 provides relevant foundations; its existence does not establish that the complete hosted platform is implemented. Section 15 separates the foundation, prototypes, and product requirements.

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# 1 Product purpose and the customer promise

Forma gives a company a home for the small applications its teams need. These apps solve defined jobs: investigating an alert, reviewing exceptions, reconciling records, coordinating a decision, or following a recurring operational process. The team should be able to create a useful tool, use it with real data, and make it available to colleagues without each app becoming a separate deployment project.

The customer promise covers the life of the app. Forma helps people bring in data, create or adapt the interface and rules, review meaningful changes, publish a version, perform work, and reuse the tool. Hosting, identity, access, saved state, application ownership, and maintenance are part of that promise. A generated screen is one step in delivering it.

The intended change in everyday work is concrete. A colleague can send a link to a reconciliation app with the relevant period, exceptions, decisions, and evidence preserved. Another colleague can continue that work, subject to access, or start a different reconciliation using the reusable app. The team does not have to reconstruct the workflow from a collection of detached files and private prompts.

## Spreadsheets as an entry point

"Spreadsheets become apps" is a useful way to introduce Forma. Someone drops in a workbook, explains the task, and obtains views and interactions suited to the data. The resulting app can retain the rules, decisions, and work that a raw table does not express on its own.

The platform also accepts supported logs, files, connected databases, and business systems. A source does not have to be a spreadsheet, and connecting a system does not mean copying its entire contents into Forma. The product makes the selected data and its handling understandable.

## Apps as the shared place of work

"The app becomes the new shared document" describes the desired experience. People share a useful working environment that includes data views, calculations, decisions, notes, and a defined workflow. They can return to it and understand what happened.

This analogy does not require every document to become an app or imply that simultaneous editing already exists. The first product supports persistent shared work and handoff. Live coediting is a later capability when it improves the actual workflow.

## The meaning of end to end

Forma can support a complete, defined digital workflow. For Northstar, that workflow is reading evidence, investigating it, documenting findings, sharing work, and reusing the app. More advanced workflows may also change an external system through a specifically supported action.

An API, MCP, AI, and data make many workflows possible. They still need correct business rules, a usable interface, persistent decisions, appropriate authority, and dependable execution. We will describe end-to-end coverage by naming the workflow and its start and finish. We will expand the product through validated app families rather than promise every function of every business at launch.

## 2 Conversation decisions and adopted defaults

The product direction evolved from an insurance demonstration to a security investigation product and then to a horizontal company platform. The newest decision governs the company description. The security work becomes the first application family on that platform, preserving the useful canvas, ingestion, generation, review, and reuse story.

The table records the decisions that should remain stable while the separate technical design is developed. Confirmed indicates direction expressed in the conversation. Default indicates a practical choice adopted for this definition.

| Decision | Status | Product consequence |
|---|---|---|
| Forma is a company app platform | Confirmed | Lead with building, running, and sharing apps over company data. |
| The app is the shared unit of work | Confirmed | Support ongoing work, saved context, handoff, and reuse. |
| Security remains the first app family | Confirmed | Retain Northstar as the first complete demonstration. |
| One platform serves different work areas | Confirmed | Use company spaces rather than separate industry products. |
| Slash commands and clicks both work | Confirmed | Both routes open the same space or app. |
| Space presentation changes promptly | Confirmed | Change relevant apps, title, accent, and context within a familiar shell. |
| Canvas and file drop remain central | Confirmed | Keep a spatial work surface and accessible upload controls. |
| Generation works with reusable building blocks | Confirmed | Find or adapt suitable tools and generate supported missing pieces. |
| Forma Stack 3.0.0 is the foundation | Confirmed | Explain its contribution without equating the framework with the finished platform. |
| Company app libraries are private by default | Default | Public distribution and cross-company templates come later. |
| Apps and saved work are distinct | Default | Reusing an app does not copy its author's evidence or authority. |
| Start with one managed cloud offering | Default | Establish a usable company account and clearly separated customer access. |
| First source workflows are read-only | Default | Support internal notes and decisions; stage external actions explicitly. |
| Browser workspace comes first | Default | Add a selected assistant host after the core experience works. |
| Sell one repeatable workflow first | Default | Use security relationships and Northstar, then test an adjacent workflow. |

The first company account may contain only one active space. That does not change the product model. Spaces can be added as teams acquire useful apps, without presenting empty industry categories as completed products.

### What carries forward from Gemini

We retain the canvas, spreadsheet and log import, prepared component pack, reuse before generation, meaningful custom views, precise edits, and the Maya to Sarah to Jordan demonstration. A specific denied operation can make the access controls tangible. Model and MCP integrations remain part of the direction, introduced in stages.

We refine the suggestion that the pivot only changes sample files. Reusable technology can carry forward, but application semantics, data interpretation, permissions, and the customer workflow still need implementation and validation. We also separate a quick presentation edit from a changed calculation.

We exclude unsupported fixed timings, a guaranteed 90 percent reuse ratio, zero service cost, claims that competitors will crash, and claims that data can never be exfiltrated. None of those assertions is needed to explain the product. Actual user outcomes and measured controls should support the pitch.

## 3 Users buyers and the first job

The initial user is a practitioner who repeatedly combines operational information, examines exceptions, records a decision, and hands work to a colleague. A security analyst is the first concrete example. Finance and operations practitioners can have comparable needs, but their data and rules must be understood separately.

The likely champion is someone who currently maintains spreadsheets, queries, scripts, dashboards, or recurring reports for a team. The purchasing sponsor is the leader accountable for that team's work and tooling. These are starting hypotheses to validate with actual customers, not evidence of demand.

| Role | Main responsibility in Forma | Desired outcome |
|---|---|---|
| Practitioner | Uses apps to examine data, make supported judgments, and save work. | Complete a recurring task with less reconstruction. |
| Builder or technical champion | Creates and adapts apps, establishes rules, and maintains useful tools. | Help colleagues without rebuilding the same workflow repeatedly. |
| Reviewer or source owner | Checks material logic, data interpretation, access, and publication changes. | Understand what is being approved and why. |
| Team leader or buyer | Chooses valuable workflows and evaluates adoption and cost. | Repeated operational value worth purchasing. |
| Organization administrator | Manages membership, spaces, policies, sources, and ownership. | Keep the company's apps usable and appropriately controlled. |

One person may hold more than one role. Northstar uses three people to make the story clear; a small team should not need three separate employees merely to operate Forma. Separation of responsibilities follows the organization's policy.

The first job to solve is: help me turn the data for a recurring investigation or exception review into a useful working app, complete the task, and let another person continue or reuse the tool. The best early pilot has a real recurring task, usable data, a named owner, and at least two people who can test the sharing and reuse promise.

We will begin with reachable security teams and the outbound investigation workflow. Expansion should follow repeated use and customer demand. A second workflow is valuable when it demonstrates that the same platform works with new data and rules without a separate custom product.

## 4 The product concepts and their relationships

Forma should present a small set of consistent concepts. They describe the experience; the technical design can choose the implementation behind them.

| Concept | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Organization | A company account with its membership, policies, and access boundaries. | Northstar |
| Space | A company-defined area containing related apps and work. | Security or Finance |
| App | A reusable tool for a defined task, including its views, rules, and permitted interactions. | Outbound Investigation |
| App version | A particular published definition of an app. | Outbound Investigation version 1 |
| Saved work | A continuing use of an app with its own context, records, notes, and state. | Maya's build-worker-17 case |
| Canvas | A working surface that arranges related views, evidence, and notes. | The six-card investigation workspace |
| Widget or card | A view or control inside an app. | Activity timeline |
| Data source or revision | Selected imported or connected information with its source history. | A connection log import and inventory revision |

Saved work is called a case in the security app. A finance app might call it a reconciliation period; an operations app might present a continuing board. The platform should allow domain-appropriate names without treating all business work as an incident.

An app definition contains what the tool needs and how it behaves. A saved case contains the actual investigation context, selected evidence, notes, and decisions. Publishing the tool and sharing the case are different operations, explained in Section 11.

A space organizes work. Access rules determine what a person can see and do within it. Space membership may participate in those rules, but a space title, theme, or slash command does not itself establish access to every app or source.

**Adopted default:** An app has one owning space and one maintained identity. Other permitted spaces may link to it without creating an unmanaged copy. A deliberate fork creates a separate app with its

own owner and history. Moving an app between spaces must make any audience or policy change visible.

## 5 Space navigation and visual identity

Forma has one recognizable platform shell. The organization selector, space navigation, app search, and access cues stay in predictable locations. A selected space changes the relevant catalog, title, icon, accent, templates, and shortcuts. Users retain their light or dark preference and other accessibility settings.

The command box offers fast navigation. Clicking remains visible and fully supported so people can discover the same destinations without remembering commands. Both methods resolve to one destination and preserve the same work state.

| User action | Destination or behavior |
| --- | --- |
| Type /security and press Enter | Open the Security space and its permitted apps. |
| Click Security in navigation | Open the same Security space. |
| Type /security/outbound and select it | Open the Outbound Investigation app in its owning space. |
| Click that app in All apps | Open the same app with Security context visible. |
| Select a timeline widget | Focus, expand, or interact within the current app. |
| Switch the organization selector | Explicitly move to another company account, if authorized. |

Typing a partial command shows matching destinations. Navigation occurs when the person presses Enter or selects a result. An unknown command explains the problem and offers permitted matches. It does not create a space, run an external action, or guess a new organization. Slash navigation belongs in the global command box and does not intercept ordinary typing in notes, log searches, or formula editors.

Routine navigation does not need an AI generation call. The shell can respond promptly while the selected app checks access and loads its data. Loading, unavailable sources, and denied access must remain visible; a fast theme change does not imply that new data is already ready.

Returning to an app restores its saved layout, filters, selected work, and notes where appropriate, while checking current access. Before leaving work, Forma saves pending changes or clearly explains any unsaved content that needs attention. State is kept within the relevant organization and work item. Switching from Security to Finance must not carry a security case's results into the finance view.

Spaces are company defined. Security, Finance, and Operations are useful examples, not a fixed list of industries. Administrators can name spaces and establish unique aliases. If an alias changes, saved links should continue to identify the same app or clearly explain the change. Ambiguous names should show the space and app together.

An empty authorized space gives an honest starting point: create an app, use an available starter, or request the access the organization permits. Search results and command suggestions must not expose private titles, thumbnails, source details, or cached findings to unauthorized people.

# 6 Home app discovery and starting work

Home answers two questions: what can I work on, and what was I doing? It shows permitted recent work, available apps, relevant spaces, and clear routes to create or upload. An app card explains its purpose, owner, current published version, required inputs, and availability.

The initial catalog is private to the organization. Search supports exact names, ordinary language, and useful filters such as space, task, owner, and publication status. People should be able to find an existing app before asking the system to create another one.

Semantic retrieval helps match intent to apps and components even when the wording differs from their names. The product checks authorization, publication status, required data, and supported behavior before offering a result for use. A similarity score alone is insufficient grounds to run an app or expose its contents.

Starting an app offers an explicit choice between continuing existing work and starting new work. A new instance asks for its purpose and compatible permitted sources. It does not silently open another user's case because the app was originally created there.

Creating an app begins with a task, a starter, or data. Forma explains the available information and proposes a useful first version. A new user should see a working starting arrangement rather than an unexplained blank canvas. Advanced users can start with an empty canvas when that fits their task.

Unpublished drafts belong to their permitted builders and reviewers. Published apps are available to their intended audiences. Retired apps remain understandable in historical work but are not recommended for new work. Apps with missing dependencies show a specific issue instead of an apparently valid empty result.

# 7 The canvas and everyday interaction

The canvas remains a central Forma capability. It allows a person to examine related views side by side, place reference material near a finding, and preserve a useful working arrangement. Security investigations are the first strong demonstration of this behavior.

The canvas supports pan and zoom, moving and resizing cards, grouping related content, useful automatic placement, and saved layouts. New content appears near the relevant work without covering it. A reset or fit-to-content control helps a person recover orientation. Keyboard navigation and a structured list or focused view provide an alternative to spatial navigation.

Related cards can share a selection or filter when the app defines that relationship. Selecting a destination can update its timeline, inventory comparison, and evidence table. The interface shows which filters are active and which views they affect. Clearing a filter returns to the prior scope predictably.

Connecting lines and grouping communicate a real relationship: a source feeds a view, or a finding references evidence. Decorative connections should not imply that the app has established a causal relationship. Data origin and a business conclusion remain distinguishable.

The app can also present a focused table, form, review queue, or step-based workflow where that serves the task. The platform should not force every routine interaction to occupy an expansive canvas. These presentations use the same app, data rules, and saved work.

### Stable work during change

Ordinary approved interactions respond directly. Expanding details or changing a permitted filter does not require a new application review. When AI proposes a new layout, view, or interaction, the change is visible and can be previewed, accepted, undone, or discarded.

The user's current work should remain available if generation fails or a proposed change is unsuitable. A targeted label edit should preserve unrelated filters and notes. A failed calculation must display an error rather than a zero. A source outage must be distinguishable from a valid result containing no matching records.

The product displays save state clearly. The case question, selected sources, findings, and decisions are shared with the case's authorized audience, subject to source access. A person's exploratory filters and layout remain personal unless deliberately saved as a shared view or included in a handoff. Published app changes have separate consequences. A team should be able to understand which changes other people will see.

## 8 Data import connections and interpretation

Data entry starts with a visible drop zone and an equivalent Upload control. Dropping a supported file onto the canvas creates a source card and begins inspection. The first release supports CSV and bounded tabular XLSX import. Supported formats, limits, and relevant restrictions are visible before upload.

The import sequence is straightforward: select the source, inspect the relevant table, confirm important field meanings, resolve material problems, and save a usable revision. The user can see progress, cancel, and understand a failure. The app preserves source history so later findings can be traced to the information used.

### Spreadsheet behavior

For CSV, the user can confirm headers, delimiters, encodings, quoted values, and missing fields. Errors identify affected rows and explain the impact. Accepted and rejected row counts remain visible; rejected records do not disappear without an explanation.

For XLSX, the user selects worksheets or tables. The first release reads supported stored values and reports formula-related limitations. It does not promise to run workbook macros, external links, or a complete Excel calculation engine. A workbook without usable values should explain the problem and the available remedy.

AI can suggest field mappings and sensitive fields. The user confirms consequential interpretations such as timezones, currency, units, identifiers, and matching keys. The product must not silently treat bytes as megabytes, local times as UTC, or an unknown account field as an approved join key.

### Source history and meaningful revisions

An import records its filename, uploader, time, source context, mapping decisions, row counts, and relevant transformations. Replacing a file creates a new revision. Existing findings remain associated with the evidence used at the time rather than quietly changing meaning when new data arrives.

Connected sources need equally clear behavior. An app explains what it reads, how current it is, whether it is a snapshot or refreshable view, and what information Forma retains. A refreshed result

should identify its new observation time or revision. Shared work must make it possible to understand which result supported a saved decision.

The first live connection will follow a repeated pilot need. Supported APIs, database connections, and MCP tools are ways to provide selected data or actions. A connector can fail, lose permission, change its schema, or return only part of a request. Those conditions must be visible and must not be presented as successful complete analysis.

### Correct analysis over the data

Each app declares the data it needs and the meaning of its calculations. Compatible column names alone do not prove that two datasets represent the same thing. Matching rules, units, time windows, deduplication, and missing data can change the outcome and need an understandable definition.

Sensitivity suggestions help apply the organization's policy, but cannot guarantee that every sensitive value was recognized. Importing evidence does not grant permission to publish or export it. Where the task can be completed with selected fields or aggregates, the app should avoid unnecessary exposure.

Large-file capability is a measured service characteristic. The product should remain responsive through progress, bounded results, filtering, cancellation, and clear supported limits. We will establish file, row, query, and concurrency limits from representative workloads rather than inherit the unverified figures in Gemini's recommendations.

## 9 Generative apps reusable modules and precise edits

Generative UI means that the working app can be created or adapted to the user's task. A request can change a view, comparison, calculation, interaction, or arrangement. The output is an inspectable application that can be kept and reused.

The product follows three possible paths. It finds a suitable existing app or component; it adapts a compatible one; or it creates a draft for supported missing functionality. Forma should explain which path it took. An unrelated preset should not be presented as successful generation.

### The prepared core pack

The first product ships useful components for summaries, tables, timelines, breakdowns, comparisons, filters, and findings. Northstar combines these into its six-card investigation app. Useful defaults reduce the amount of work required before a user can begin.

The pack should grow from real tasks. Generation may reuse a table renderer while introducing a new comparison or calculation. The value lies in the new working behavior, not in inventing an unfamiliar visual primitive each time. Reuse is measured across customer work; there is no fixed 90 percent promise.

### The role of the vector database

The intended vector capability helps discover relevant apps and modules by meaning, supports finding reusable structures, and can assist targeted adaptation where the application supports it. It is a discovery and reuse capability, not a replacement for access checks or validated calculations.

Exact totals, record matching, and evidence references come from the permitted data operations defined by the app. A semantically similar result does not establish a correct answer. The registry must

respect organization boundaries and avoid returning private app content, evidence, or metadata through search.

### Creation guidance and reviewable changes

The request interface helps the person specify the task, relevant sources, desired result, and missing information. It asks a focused question when an unresolved interpretation would materially affect the result. Routine choices use visible defaults. Requests outside supported capabilities receive a clear limitation and an actionable next step.

The user can inspect a draft, test it against representative permitted data, and accept or undo proposed changes. Generation has a visible state, including partial completion and failure. A working published app remains available while a new version is being developed.

Precise edits are an important experience. Changing a title should change that title. Changing the layout should preserve the investigation where possible. Changing a measure requires its actual definition to change. For example, converting total bytes to bytes per minute requires a defined time interval, denominator, and unit; renaming the metric would be incorrect.

Material changes to shared logic, sources, joins, or actions create a draft subject to the publication policy. Personal arrangement and approved filtering remain ordinary use. The interface should make this difference understandable without exposing internal runtime machinery to every user.

## 10 Workflows decisions and external actions

An app should define what completion means. An investigation ends with a supported handoff or a documented unresolved question. A reconciliation ends with explained matches and exceptions. A review queue records decisions and remaining work. A dashboard that displays numbers without helping a person complete the intended task may be insufficient for the product promise.

The first release reads source data and supports work inside Forma: notes, findings, status, ownership, and review records. This is enough to complete the first investigation workflow. It does not automatically authorize writing to source systems or sending messages externally.

An external action becomes a product capability only when its meaning, authority, and result are defined. A button labeled Approve might record an internal decision, authorize a payment, or update a source record. Those effects must be explicit before the person uses it.

For each supported external action, the app explains what will change, where it will change, who can perform it, and whether approval is required. It shows progress and the observed result. A timeout can leave the outcome uncertain; the interface must not convert uncertainty into an unsupported success claim.

Retry behavior must account for duplicate effects. The connected system's capabilities determine how an action can be retried or reconciled safely. AWS's guidance on idempotent APIs illustrates why repeating a request can otherwise create unintended duplicate work. The product requirement is a reliable, understandable recovery path, not an unqualified exactly-once guarantee. [8]

**Adopted default:** Add one bounded external action only after a pilot establishes that the action is necessary to finish a valuable recurring workflow. Retain human control for the relevant approvals. Longer automation chains and scheduled execution follow explicit scope decisions and evidence of usefulness.

For example, a future order-exception app could compare orders with shipments, present the discrepancy, record an owner's decision, perform one approved follow-up, and verify its result. That is a defined workflow expansion. It does not imply that Forma has become a complete order-management system.

## 11 Collaboration sharing and independent reuse

Forma supports collaboration through persistent work with a known audience. Colleagues should be able to see the permitted evidence, active context, findings, decisions, and remaining questions without reconstructing the author's private conversation with AI.

The product distinguishes three sharing operations at the point of use.

| Sharing operation | What is shared | What remains independently controlled |
|---|---|---|
| Share an app | A reusable tool and its published behavior. | The recipient's data, work context, and current access. |
| Share saved work | A particular case, review, or board with its permitted content and state. | Audience, edit rights, source access, and sensitive content. |
| Share an export | A selected snapshot or handoff for a stated audience. | Export permission, included fields, and subsequent distribution. |

Reusing an app must not silently copy the author's evidence, private notes, credentials, or privileges. The next person selects a new case or work item and compatible data. Forma checks field meanings and current access. Missing inputs or permissions produce an explanation rather than an apparent successful result.

Sharing the same case intentionally allows colleagues to work on that case, within the permissions granted. App access and data access remain distinct. A person may be allowed to use Outbound Investigation without being allowed to read Maya's particular evidence.

**Adopted default:** Findings placed in a shared case are shared with its authorized audience, which stays visible. Personal drafts are clearly marked and remain private until deliberately added. The first release supports saved handoff and change history, with clear handling when someone edits a stale version. It does not promise live simultaneous coediting.

An export identifies its source context, relevant version, filters, and time where needed for interpretation. Revocation prevents future authorized access through Forma; it cannot recall information someone already saw, copied, or exported. The sharing experience should make the audience and content concrete before distribution.

## 12 Publication ownership and application lifecycle

The visible lifecycle is Draft, In review, Published, and Retired. A published app can have a separate draft. People using the current approved version should not encounter unfinished changes from its author.

Review focuses on what materially changes: data sources and fields, interpretations, calculations, joins, interactions, external actions, and requested access. The reviewer sees a concise difference summary,

representative results, and a route to inspect details. The product should reduce repeated review of unchanged approved behavior.

**Adopted default:** New shared apps and material changes follow the organization's publication policy. Routine filtering, personal arrangement, and ordinary notes within approved behavior do not trigger app publication review. The Northstar demonstration uses Sarah as reviewer; other organizations can assign appropriate responsibilities without reproducing those fictional personas.

Published versions have a stable identity and an owner. New work starts with the current permitted published version. Existing saved work records the version used. When a newer version is available, the app explains the relevant changes and an authorized user explicitly chooses whether to apply a compatible update to that saved work. Material calculation changes must not silently rewrite the meaning of earlier findings.

Rollback restores an available, compatible version and preserves history. It does not restore revoked permission or erase intervening work. A critical security restriction can prevent further use of a previously published version even if a case was saved with it.

Owners maintain descriptions, input requirements, dependencies, and useful defaults. When a source changes, the app identifies affected work and the need for repair. A departing builder should not leave the company with an ownerless tool. Administration includes transferring responsibility and retiring obsolete apps.

Retirement removes an app from recommended new work while retaining an understandable historical record according to retention policy. Deleting work, deleting a source revision, and retiring an app are separate actions with different consequences. The product should explain those consequences and avoid silently breaking referenced findings.

# 13 Secure cloud organization access and data handling

For this product, secure cloud means that Forma operates the hosted application service and provides clear controls over company membership, app publication, data use, and permitted actions. It also means taking responsibility for service operation, recovery, ownership, and understandable failure states.

The managed offering hosts company accounts, the apps and their runtime experience, and the work the service promises to preserve. It can use existing identity services. The product does not require inventing a new identity provider or copying every connected database into Forma.

### Companies and tenancy

The intended service supports multiple organizations with separate membership, app libraries, sources, policies, and work. Shared product infrastructure must not imply shared customer data. Whether particular resources are shared or dedicated belongs in the technical design and deployment offering.

A single-organization pilot can demonstrate a useful workflow. Claiming that the service serves multiple companies securely requires verification of those boundaries, including search, cached results, files, background work, and administration. A themed space is not a substitute for organization separation.

The default is one managed service. Dedicated environments, customer-hosted arrangements, and additional regional offerings are later commercial choices when actual demand supports their cost. The product description should not promise all deployment modes at launch.

### Access throughout use

Discovering an app, running it, viewing its data, editing its definition, reviewing publication, and exporting results are different permissions. The service evaluates current authority when work is opened and when data or actions are requested. A copied link, saved layout, or slash command does not grant authority.

AI can propose a change but cannot approve its own broader access. Sensitive operations require the organization's applicable authorization. A visible denial should state the practical limitation and allowed next step without exposing protected data.

Imported files, logs, and external text can contain instructions intended to influence a model. OWASP describes this indirect prompt-injection risk and notes that retrieval alone does not remove it. Forma's product requirements therefore keep evidence separate from authority and test specific prohibited operations. [7]

We will demonstrate the controls actually implemented and tested. A version hash identifies particular content; it does not prove correct logic or universal safety. Runtime restrictions contribute to protection, while source authorization, content admission, operational controls, and review remain application responsibilities.

### Data handling and service expectations

Customers need to understand what is stored, what is sent to a model, where relevant processing occurs, how long work and sources remain available, and how deletion affects history. Generated summaries and search indexes can contain sensitive information too. Policies apply to them as well as to original files.

The first offering needs clear save behavior, recovery expectations, support ownership, and usage limits. It must explain whether a result is current, stale, partially loaded, or unavailable. Formal service commitments follow operational evidence rather than an unsupported availability promise.

Government and regulated industries remain possible future customers. Selecting a cloud provider or using encryption does not establish Forma's own compliance status. Any FedRAMP claim must refer to an actual offering and its verified status; current FedRAMP guidance also distinguishes the cloud service certification from an agency's authorization of its use. [9]

## 14 AI APIs and MCP in the product

AI interprets intent, suggests data mappings, finds or adapts tools, creates supported missing behavior, and helps draft explanations. People should be able to see and correct consequential choices. An AI explanation must be traceable to evidence when it makes claims about company data.

APIs and connectors provide the operations a source system exposes. MCP is another integration mechanism for tools and context. The official protocol describes tools, resources, and prompts; it does not define every application's business rules or replace the host's product responsibilities. An app does not need both a separate API integration and MCP integration for every source. [5]

The platform adds the shared experience around those ingredients: identity, app ownership, persistent work, defined calculations, publication, permitted actions, and reliable use. Generative UI gives the task an adaptable interaction layer within that product.

### Model policy and predictable use

The first release supports a chosen generation provider under an explicit organization data policy. Where schemas and synthetic examples are enough, generation should use them. Sending sensitive records to a model requires a clear supported policy and customer understanding of the actual provider arrangement.

Additional providers or customer-controlled model accounts can follow demand. The interface should make the selected provider, relevant data handling, and usage visible. A provider selection alone is not proof of a particular residency, retention, or compliance guarantee.

Opening an approved app, navigating spaces, filtering supported data, and recording ordinary work should not require regenerating the application. If generation is unavailable, existing apps should continue where their other dependencies permit. Apps that genuinely require a model for a specific operation must show that dependency and its failure state.

Generation, storage, queries, and support have costs even when an existing component is reused. Customers need understandable usage limits and feedback before an expensive or long-running operation. Public performance and cost claims will follow measurements of the supported product.

### Assistant surfaces

The browser workspace is the initial home. Later, a selected app or view may be available within a supported assistant through MCP Apps. The official extension supports interactive interfaces inside compatible hosts, with host-specific integration and capabilities. [6]

The goal is to reuse the approved app behavior and data rules across surfaces where practical. A shared resource address alone does not make the app portable with zero work. Each supported host must be validated for identity, permitted data, interactions, state, and its actual sandbox behavior. A public website builder is not part of the first platform release.

## 15 Why Forma Stack matters and what is established

Forma Stack 3.0.0 is the foundation reference for this product. Its architecture describes a compiler, Rust rendering, browser signals and islands, and an explicit HTML runtime. Its runtime security model includes owned roots, declared tiers, and grants for specific capabilities. These are relevant foundations for composed interfaces and controlled behavior. [2][3]

They support the reason for building Forma: treating applications as structured, reusable software that can be composed and changed deliberately. The platform applies that foundation to people creating and sharing small tools over company data. Its business value will depend on whether the complete experience reduces the effort of creation, review, use, and maintenance.

The security policies also state responsibilities and limits. Mounting constraints are not a universal HTML sanitizer. The hosting application must admit content and assign appropriate privileges. The reviewed 3.0 code treats compiled FMIR modules as trusted application-build output; general admission of arbitrary untrusted modules is not supplied by that boundary. [3][4]

| Area | What is established for this definition |
| --- | --- |
| Forma Stack foundation | Selected 3.0 documentation and source policies support the framework capabilities described here. |

| Area | What is established for this definition |
| --- | --- |
| Security and navigation prototypes | Existing demonstrations illustrate the narrative and interactions; fixture behavior is not proof of production enforcement. |
| Full company platform | Organization administration, app hosting, data workflows, lifecycle, and independent reuse must be demonstrated together. |
| Performance and security outcomes | Require product-level measurement and validation on supported workloads and boundaries. |

The review of the foundation does not establish that the complete canvas, ingestion service, vector registry, application review process, or multi-organization operations are finished. Some of that work may exist elsewhere. Its readiness must be stated from the relevant application evidence, not inferred from the framework version number.

Another team could build a comparable customer experience with different technology. Forma's stack becomes an advantage when it makes useful apps easier to create, constrain, adapt, and maintain. The pitch should connect technical work to those outcomes and avoid claiming that a language or runtime alone makes competitors incapable.

**Founder explanation:** I built Forma around structured, reusable applications and precise changes. The platform gives that foundation a practical purpose: teams can create the small tools their work needs, run them over permitted data, and share them as maintained apps. Northstar demonstrates the first complete workflow; the same platform can support other validated workflows.

# 16 The Northstar story on the platform

Northstar is the fictional company used to demonstrate Forma. Maya is an analyst, Sarah is a reviewer, and Jordan is a teammate. Their roles make creation, publication, and independent reuse visible. They are not customer traction claims.

The first app helps investigate unusual outbound activity from build-worker-17. It consumes evidence from existing sources. An alert, large transfer, or destination missing from an inventory does not by itself establish compromise.

## Act 1 Enter the company space and bring in evidence

Maya opens Northstar in Forma, types /security, and sees the same Security space she could reach by clicking. She starts new investigation work and drops in a connection-event CSV and an approved-destination workbook.

Forma shows import progress, source details, and data-quality issues. Maya confirms relevant fields, timezones, units, and the inventory interpretation. The source revisions become part of the case. The demo must distinguish actual parsing from fixture behavior wherever a prototype is used.

## Act 2 State the investigation question

Maya asks for outbound activity, unfamiliar destinations, and the ownership context for build-worker-17. Forma shows the available evidence and suggests an appropriate investigation app or component set. If historical data is missing, it cannot imply that a statistical anomaly baseline has already been established.

The product reuses permitted compatible modules and identifies missing behavior. The analyst can correct the intended question or supply additional context before a material assumption becomes part of the calculation.

### Act 3 Assemble and refine the working app

The canvas presents six coordinated cards. They offer a useful default and can be refined for the current investigation.

| Card | Job in the investigation |
| --- | --- |
| Case summary | Show the asset, question, window, source revisions, and defined metrics. |
| Activity timeline | Show when activity occurred and link selections to underlying records. |
| Destination breakdown | Compare observed destinations and transfer measures. |
| Inventory comparison | Explain supported matches, missing entries, and reference limitations. |
| Evidence table | Inspect, filter, and reference permitted source records. |
| Findings and handoff | Preserve observations, supporting evidence, uncertainty, and next steps. |

Maya asks for a missing comparison, previews the draft, and accepts it. A local wording or layout edit preserves the rest of the work. A new rate or grouping changes the actual definition and exposes its meaning. Selecting a destination cross-filters the related cards within their approved behavior.

### Act 4 Review and publish the reusable app

Sarah reviews the proposed shared app and its meaningful changes: required inputs, calculations, matching rules, and requested capabilities. The approved version is published to its intended audience in Northstar's app library. Maya's case evidence is not automatically published with it.

The demo can show one specifically unauthorized operation being refused, including an attempted request influenced by an attacker-controlled log field. Show the actual enforced boundary when available. A simulated refusal is labeled as simulated, and a blocked request is not presented as proof that all prompt-injection risks are eliminated.

### Act 5 Investigate and hand off the case

Maya examines the activity, follows evidence references, records supported observations, and identifies unresolved questions. The app explains the inventory revision and match rules. An absent entry remains an absent entry, not an automatic verdict of malicious activity.

She shares the saved case with the appropriate colleague or prepares a permitted handoff export. The recipient can understand the source context, relevant filters, findings, and next action. External notifications or response actions occur only if a separately supported and authorized workflow exists.

### Act 6 Reuse the app for different work

Jordan receives a new alert involving ops-runner-04. He finds the published app in Security and starts a new case. Forma checks his data compatibility and current access, then runs the same approved tool for his evidence.

Jordan gets the useful investigation method without Maya's private records, notes, or credentials. The app can be used without regenerating the complete interface. This second person's successful use is the key platform payoff: a tool created during one task becomes maintained software that the company can use again.

# 17 Other app families and the creator platform analogy

The platform is horizontal at the level of creation, running, sharing, and maintenance. Each useful app family still requires appropriate data meaning and workflow rules. A new space alone does not create domain expertise.

The following are illustrative extensions, not a launch catalog or customer list.

| Space or team | Example inputs | Example app | Domain work still required |
|---|---|---|---|
| Security | Connection events and asset inventory | Outbound investigation | Time windows, match rules, evidence interpretation |
| Finance operations | Invoices and payment records | Reconciliation and exceptions | Currency, matching, tolerances, review authority |
| Operations | Orders, shipments, and stock records | Fulfillment exception review | Status meaning, expected dates, ownership |
| Support | Tickets and account context | Escalation workspace | Priority rules, customer context, permitted follow-up |
| Healthcare operations | Staffing and capacity schedules | Coverage review | Role definitions, coverage requirements, sensitive data handling |

The healthcare example concerns operational coordination. Clinical decision support, medical diagnosis, and other specialized uses require their own validated product scope. Government use similarly follows actual customer, deployment, and applicable requirements.

The common building blocks include source inspection, tables, comparisons, timelines, filters, notes, review, publication, and reuse. The variable parts include business definitions, supported integrations, calculations, actions, and the evidence required to trust the result.

### What the Roblox analogy contributes

The useful analogy is a creator platform. Forma supplies the environment to create an app, run it, discover it, and reuse it. An organization's app library is the place its people find their work tools. Reusable components and templates make subsequent creation easier.

For the initial product, each company has its own permitted app catalog. There is no automatic sharing of company data across organizations. A future template exchange would distribute selected app definitions or starter components separately from evidence, credentials, and access.

The analogy is a way to explain the product structure. It does not establish a marketplace, network effect, or a particular economic outcome. Lead with the customer's working experience; use the analogy when it helps the audience understand the broader platform ambition.

# 18 Release scope and product completeness

The first release must complete the platform loop for one useful app family. Its quality is judged by whether real users can create or adapt an app, publish it, perform work, and let another person reuse it with the right data and access.

## First usable platform

The initial scope includes a company account and authenticated membership, a private app catalog, company-defined spaces, and both slash and click navigation. It includes clear app ownership and the ability to continue existing work or start a new instance.

The working experience includes a saved canvas, CSV and bounded XLSX import, visible data interpretation, the prepared core pack, permitted discovery, and meaningful generation within supported capabilities. Users can refine the app, inspect calculations, undo proposed changes, and keep source-linked findings.

Sharing includes app publication, saved-case handoff, explicit export, independent access evaluation, and a known application version. The product distinguishes personal display changes from material shared-app changes. Denials, source problems, missing inputs, and save failures are understandable.

The source relationship is read-only. Users can write notes and decisions inside Forma. Northstar's six acts must work as a coherent journey rather than six disconnected demonstrations. The hosted service must preserve the work and support the operational responsibilities stated in Section 13.

## First extensions after demonstrated use

Add one live connector selected from repeated pilot needs. Validate an adjacent workflow using the same platform. Introduce one bounded external action only if it completes a real task that the read and review workflow cannot finish. Refine administration and usage visibility from operating the service.

A selected MCP Apps host is a separate extension after the browser workflow is dependable. Its priority follows user demand. More model choices and customer-controlled model accounts should solve concrete customer requirements.

## Later possibilities

Live simultaneous editing, scheduled workflows, broader action integrations, more app packs, dedicated deployments, and cross-company template distribution remain possible expansions. A public marketplace is a later choice. None is a condition for proving the first useful private company platform.

The initial product does not include packet capture, a replacement SIEM, a general log-retention business, autonomous containment, employee performance scoring, a public website builder, or unsupported compliance claims. These boundaries preserve a coherent first workflow while leaving the platform extensible.

## Evidence of product completeness

Before describing the platform as ready for its supported use, demonstrate that a second user can complete the workflow independently, a saved case reopens with its context intact, a revoked permission prevents further access, and a changed source or calculation produces an understandable state.

Also demonstrate that a published app remains usable when a new draft or generation attempt fails; that a reused app binds to the new user's permitted data; and that organization boundaries hold wherever the offering claims to serve multiple companies. These are customer outcomes and trust requirements, not a substitute for the separate engineering validation plan.

## 19 Adoption measurement and the commercial approach

The initial commercial hypothesis is a managed platform subscription for a team or organization, with understandable included usage and limits. Exact prices and billable units remain open. Earlier illustrative customer names, prices, and revenue scenarios are not traction.

Begin with a bounded pilot around a repeated real workflow. Establish how the team currently performs the task, who does the preparation and review, and what makes the result useful. Compare Forma across the whole process, including cleanup, creation, publication, investigation, handoff, and the next reuse.

| Measure | What it should establish |
|---|---|
| Time to a useful approved app | Whether creation and review together improve the process. |
| Preparation and cleanup effort | Whether import and interpretation save work overall. |
| Correctness and traceability | Whether calculations and findings retain their supporting evidence. |
| Second-person reuse | Whether an app survives beyond its author's original case. |
| Repeat use without founder operation | Whether the product is understandable and independently valuable. |
| Maintenance and reviewer effort | Whether useful apps remain affordable to keep working. |
| Service cost per completed workflow | Whether generation, queries, storage, and support costs permit a viable offering. |
| Willingness to pay and continued use | Whether the value supports a commercial relationship. |

Measure reuse across later work, not merely repeated loading of the same fixture. Measure perceived speed from the request to a usable result, not only a narrow retrieval or DOM operation. Include relevant file sizes, data conditions, and concurrency when publishing performance results.

The first expansion should follow evidence that the platform components transfer. If each new app requires a custom rebuild, that is a product learning to address. If customers mainly need better detection or a new source of data, the investigation app may not solve their most valuable problem.

Pricing should reinforce adoption of useful apps while accounting for service cost. An organization subscription with bounded usage is a sensible starting hypothesis. The final commercial unit should follow the buyer's value, procurement needs, and observed workload rather than a predetermined price copied from an earlier example.

# 20 Positioning the YC connection and the explanation to use

Lead with the platform's customer job, then use one concrete app to demonstrate it. The company's scope can be horizontal while its first sales conversations and demo remain specific.

## The verified YC request

The relevant request is **A Cloud for Small Software**, by **Pete Koomen**, in YC's **Fall 2026** Requests for Startups. It discusses the difficulty of deploying and sharing small team tools, including authentication, permissions, company customization, and secure distribution. Its central line is: "Small software should be as easy to share with your colleagues as a Google Doc." [1]

Our interpretation is that Forma aligns with that problem by giving company apps a place to run and be shared with maintained access and work state. The request does not prescribe a security-only app, and it is not a promise to fund Forma. Customer evidence and a working product still determine the strength of the business case.

## Platform explanation

Forma is a platform where teams build, run, and share AI-generated apps over their company data. Bring in a spreadsheet or connect a supported system, describe the task, and create a working app. Your team can use it in a shared company space, keep the decisions and evidence, and reuse it for the next job.

## Short customer explanation

Forma is where your company's small apps live. Your team can create a tool for the way it works, publish it to the right people, and return to the same app and saved work. Security, finance, and operations can have their own spaces within the same platform.

## First application explanation

Our first app family helps security teams turn logs and reference data into reusable investigation tools. In the Northstar story, Maya creates the tool, Sarah reviews the shared version, and Jordan uses it for another case with his own data and permissions.

## The reason for building the framework

I built Forma to make software structured, reusable, and easier to change precisely. The platform uses that foundation to help teams create small apps that can be run, reviewed, and shared over company data. The outcome we need to prove is less effort to create and maintain useful tools, with clear behavior and appropriate access.

## The claims that earn the position

The proposed distinction is the complete workflow: data interpretation, adaptable interaction, durable work, reviewable app changes, and independent reuse in one hosted environment. We need to demonstrate those benefits against the customer's current process. Assertions about competitors' internal stacks or universal inability to handle data do not establish the advantage.

Describe the live product separately from the vision. Show what is implemented, label fixture or simulated behavior, state measured supported limits, and identify the next capability under

development. The platform ambition should remain clear without presenting every planned extension as a current feature.

# 21 Reference notes

External references were reviewed on October 22, 2026. The Forma foundation references below identify the specific 3.0 revision used for this explanation. They support the stated framework properties and limits; they are not a product-level benchmark or audit of the completed cloud service.


[1] Y Combinator Requests for Startups. Fall 2026, A Cloud for Small Software by Pete Koomen. The official page contains the request and its author. Open reference

[2] Forma 3.0 architecture. Foundation packages, rendering, browser behavior, and explicit HTML runtime at commit 2006423b21fe0f8dd5a510bd09bfe3b8748327a5. Open reference

[3] Forma core security policy at the same revision. Explicit mount ownership, grants, raw markup responsibilities, and stated limits. Open reference

[4] Forma Stack security policy at the same revision. Trusted FMIR input and the boundary around untrusted module admission. Open reference

[5] Model Context Protocol architecture overview. Official description of hosts, tools, resources, prompts, and protocol scope. Open reference

[6] Model Context Protocol MCP Apps overview. Interactive interfaces, host integration, and host-dependent support. Open reference

[7] OWASP Gen AI Security Project. Prompt Injection guidance, including indirect instructions in external content and the limits of retrieval as a mitigation. Open reference

[8] Amazon Builders Library. Making retries safe with idempotent APIs, explaining duplicate side effects and retry semantics. Open reference

[9] FedRAMP Consolidated Rules for 2026. Using a FedRAMP Certified Cloud Service, including the distinction between service certification and agency authorization. Open reference


# 22 Remaining open decisions

The platform identity, company spaces, navigation, shared-app model, and Northstar story are settled. The following choices require customer or operating evidence. Their defaults allow work to proceed.

### First paying customer and buyer

**Default:** Start with an accessible security team doing repeated investigation or exception review, with a champion, sponsor, and at least two users. **Resolve through:** observed work, an agreed pilot, independent use, and willingness to pay. Broaden the buyer profile if an adjacent workflow has stronger evidence.

### First live connection

**Default:** Retain file import and add one source repeatedly needed by pilots. **Resolve through:** frequency of use, permission and API feasibility, data meaning, maintenance burden, and time saved. The first release does not require a broad integration catalog.

### First external action

**Default:** Launch with source reads and internal work records. Add one bounded action when a valuable task otherwise remains incomplete. **Resolve through:** its intended effect, authorized actor, supported source behavior, and recovery path. Connecting an API does not authorize this expansion.

### Model provider and sensitive data policy

**Default:** Use one supported provider, minimize record exposure, and state the data policy. **Resolve through:** quality, cost, buyer requirements, provider terms, regional processing, and permitted use of sensitive content. Customer-controlled model accounts follow demonstrated demand.

### Service limits and operating commitments

**Default:** Publish only measured supported file, row, query, concurrency, and usage limits. **Resolve through:** representative workloads, failure recovery, cost, and actual operating evidence. Set appropriate retention and support commitments for the first customer agreement rather than inherit unverified timing or scale claims.

### Pricing and billable unit

**Default:** Test a team or organization subscription with clear included usage. **Resolve through:** repeated customer value, active use, service costs, support effort, and purchasing behavior. Do not present an illustrative price as a validated willingness to pay.

### Adjacent app family after Northstar

**Default:** Choose one finance or operations exception-review workflow with an owner and recurring data. **Resolve through:** user access, expected value, and whether the same platform works through configuration, components, and supported connections. Industry labels alone do not establish useful apps.

### Additional deployment and regulated market requirements

**Default:** Offer one managed service with clear company separation and an accurately stated data policy. **Resolve through:** qualified customer needs for dedicated resources, geography, contractual controls, or a particular regulated offering, together with the cost of operating it. No compliance status is assumed.

### Priority of live coediting and assistant hosts

**Default:** Deliver persistent shared work in the browser first. **Resolve through:** whether simultaneous editing or a particular assistant is essential to recurring work, plus validated host behavior. Choose the first extension from that evidence.

### Cross company templates and a public marketplace

**Default:** Keep organization catalogs private. **Resolve through:** template or partner demand, content rights, review and support responsibilities, and separation from company evidence and credentials. A marketplace remains a later business decision.